

The 3-Pass Neighborhood Check

Before you fall for a house, test the life around it. Three visits reveal the traffic, noise, parking and nighttime feel a polished showing can hide—then four official checks fill in what your eyes cannot.

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The Morning Pass

- Drive your real weekday route in both directions—not the app's best-case estimate.
- Watch school drop-off, cut-through traffic and whether backing out feels easy or exposed.
- Read every curb sign: street sweeping, permit zones, tow-away hours and time limits.
- Pause with the windows down. Listen for freeway hum, aircraft, construction and barking dogs.

AM • FLOW

3

The Afternoon Read

- See where residents actually park once school and work begin to let out.
- Notice garages used as storage, double-parking, delivery traffic and blocked driveways.
- Check the home's sun and heat exposure; a bright room at noon can bake by late afternoon.
- Walk to the places you expect to use. A "nearby" market or park may not feel comfortably walkable.

PM • USE

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The Night Walk

- Come on a weeknight and again on Friday or Saturday if nightlife or event traffic is nearby.
- Look at lighting, sidewalk condition, visibility from the house and how the block feels on foot.
- Listen for venue spillover, late deliveries, gatherings and engines you missed during the day.
- Ask the simplest question: would you feel good arriving home here alone?



FROM JULIA

"A house can look perfect at a 2 PM showing and feel completely different on a Friday night."

Do all three passes before you write the offer, not after.

BEFORE YOU WRITE

Four official checks before the offer.

DESK CHECK 01

Zoning, permits + future change

Use L.A. City Planning's ZIMAS to check zoning, overlays, planning cases, building permits and code history. Then look for pending projects nearby—the quiet view you love may not stay unchanged.

DESK CHECK 02

School assignment—not reputation

Confirm the exact address in LAUSD's Resident School Identifier. Boundaries and enrollment models vary; a listing's school label or third-party rating is not an enrollment promise.

DESK CHECK 03

Current incident patterns

Review LAPD's current NIBRS data by time, location and incident type. Compare like periods and look for patterns; one headline or a broad ZIP-code score can distort the block-level picture.

DESK CHECK 04

Hazards + insurability

Run the address through Cal OES MyHazards for earthquake, flood, fire and tsunami layers, then price insurance before contingencies are removed. A map is a starting point—not a substitute for disclosures.